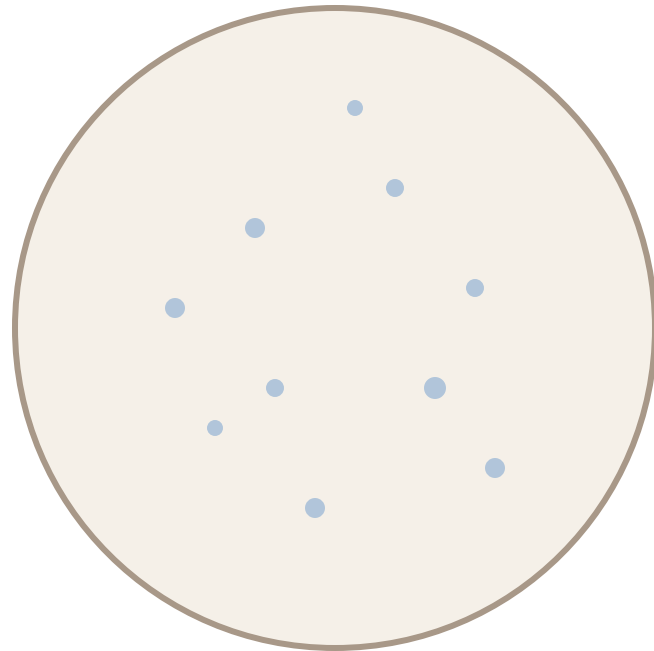
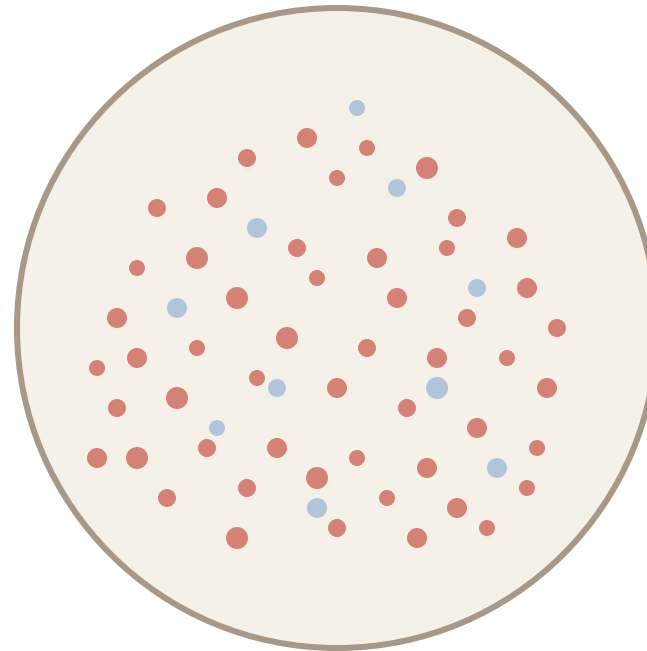


Negative Control
(cell media only)



10 SFU
Background

Drug Well
(raw count)

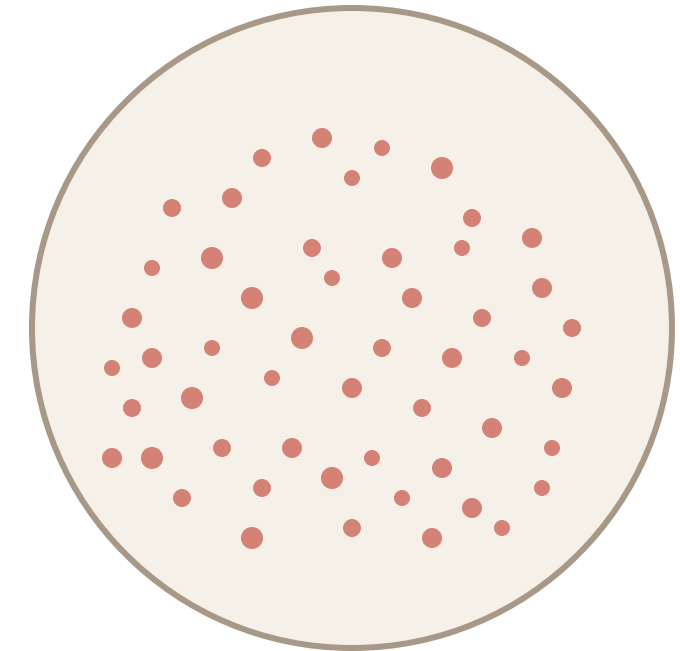


110 SFU
Raw count

– 10 SFU

subtract
background

Drug Well
(background removed)



100 SFU
Drug-specific response

POSITIVE

● Drug-specific IFN- γ spot

● Non-specific background spot

Drug well (110) – Neg control (10) = 100 SFU

Background subtraction: Each spot = one T cell secreting IFN- γ . Negative control captures non-specific activation. Subtracting the negative control count from the drug well count isolates the **drug-specific T-cell response**.

Positivity criteria: ≥ 50 SFU/ 10^6 cells (background-subtracted) **and/or** stimulation index $\geq 3 \times$ negative control (here: $110/10 = 11 \times$).

Duplicate or triplicate wells are run for each condition; results averaged before interpretation.